

Invisible QR Codes

An invisible quick response (QR) code has been created by researchers in an attempt to increase security on printed documents



Meet Baxter

Baxter is like most reliable employees, he uses common sense to do his job, and works well with others — except, he's a robot

Bazaar

Huawei Ascend G300 (U8815)

A budget Android smartphone with a very good display

On first impressions, the device is very well built. It is a little heavier than other smartphones in the same price bracket which makes it more sturdy.

On the face, the Huawei Ascend has a 4-inch display with a resolution of 480x800, which is standard for the budget smartphones. The best part of the display is that it is an IPS panel capacitive touchscreen display making it really sharp.

We tried to run a bunch of MOV and MKV files on it but they didn't run. Simple AVI files however ran very



smoothly without any hiccups. The viewing angles are good and the video looks crisp. The audio from the device too is good. It screeches a bit at full volume but is loud nonetheless.

The OS comes with a Huawei Launcher, which isn't the best when compared to the likes of Samsung TouchWiz or

HTC Sense and is quite bland making the device very laggy.

The rear 5MP camera clicks average quality images, the same that you would find on the original HTC Desire.

The keyboard has three different layouts: first is the standard QWERTY; second is the three letters per key that we find on candybar phones and the final layout is a QWERTY two letters per key layout. These layouts are available in both portrait as well as landscape mode.

The battery life of the device is good. While using Wi-Fi, making calls and running a few apps, the device lasted for two days. Do check this device out.

Sameer Mitha

Specifications

Platform: Android 2.3 Gingerbread upgradable to Android 4.0 ICS; **Processor:** 1 GHz Cortex-A5; **RAM:** 512MB; **Display:** 4.0-inch HD- IPS LCD, 480 x 800 pixels; **Storage:** 4GB storage (2.5GB user available), with microSD slot up to 32GB; **Camera:** 5MP; **Battery:** 1500mAh

Contact

Phone: +91 124 4825700
e-mail: huawe.in@gmail.com
Price: ₹13,500



Features	5.0
Performance.....	6.0
Build Quality	8.0
Value for Money	5.0

HCL Me Tab Y2

Good display but lacks access to the Google Play store

Specifications

Platform: Android 4.0.3, **Processor:** 1GHz, **RAM:** 1GB, **Display:** 7-inch IPS (1024 x 600 pixels), **Storage:** 8 GB internal expandable up to 32GB via a micro SD card, **Camera:** 2MP rear & 0.3 video call, **Battery:** 4000 mAh

Contact

Phone: +91-120-2520917/ 937
Price: ₹14,999



Features	5.0
Performance.....	5.0
Build Quality	7.0
Value for Money	5.0

The HCL Me Tab Y2 has a premium finish to it and the screen has a wider aspect ratio making it ideal for watching videos. It is a little heavy weighing 368 gm.

The HCL Me Tab Y2 runs on Google Android 4.0.3 ICS. The device isn't skinned but it does have a HCL feel to it. It comes preloaded with a bunch of apps and games. The device compromises on the Google Play store and in turn adds its own HCL Me app store on the device. The Google Play Store is dearly missed. The display on the



well, even under direct sunlight. Audio is soft, flat and gives a very lacklustre performance.

You can insert your SIM card and use the device as a phone but that's not practical really.

The inbuilt Android browser isn't the best as web pages take time to load and navigation can get very laggy at times. Scrolling and zooming was cumbersome and quite frustrating. The HCL Me Tab lasted for four hours in the continuous video playback test which is good.

The device is really good and probably one of the best we have seen on a budget tablet. It is a 7-inch IPS display with a resolution of 1024 x 600. We do wish that the resolution was a bit better but we are just nit picking. The display is very vibrant and the colours look sharp. It has fantastic viewing angles as

Sameer Mitha